

Voice & Ideology Brief

What David Latimer's book taught us —
and how the site now speaks in his voice.

DISTILLED FROM THE MANUSCRIPT · 73,000 WORDS

Source: *Behavior Book* (working manuscript) · **Prepared:** August 8, 2026

This brief is the reference for all future K9School copy, so every page keeps sounding like David.

Behavior Is Evidence

David's entire philosophy compresses into one line from the book: "**The sit was not the discovery. It was the communication.**" The profession trains, rewards, documents, and testifies about the final response. David trains the *search before the sit* — the behavioral sequence where the dog actually does its work.

The through-line

A detector dog is always communicating. The handler's job is to read the conversation — and to be able to explain and defend it later. Reliability isn't claimed; it's demonstrated and documented.

The five pillars we now lead with

- ◆ **Behavior is evidence** — read the dog, don't just reward the sit.
- ◆ **Field-first** — "proven in the field, not just the yard."
- ◆ **The whole team** — "handler, heal thyself"; train the human end of the leash.
- ◆ **Courtroom-defensible** — train for scrutiny; every exercise is future evidence.
- ◆ **Integrity over winning** — the goal is truth, not beating anyone.

The vocabulary that is now on the site

The Five Phases of Detector Dog Behavior

1) Responds to the search command · 2) Systematic search (no odor yet) · 3) Detection · 4) Change of behavior · 5) Trained final response. **Phases 3–4 are the investigation.**

The Four Classes of Behavior

Intrinsic · Trained · Independently learned · **Handler-influenced** (the dangerous one).

Reading the dog — "every dog has an accent"

Respiration (first tell), head position, tail carriage, footwork; establish a baseline, then watch for change.

His systems & principles

- ◆ **The Scent Board System** — teach dogs to *think before they alert*; discrimination, bracketing, source commitment.
- ◆ **Build independent dogs** — blank searches, productive failure, teach the dog to say "I don't know," reward the investigation.
- ◆ **The Invisible Leash** — handler influence (Clever Hans; Dr. Lisa Lit's research); four channels: physical, visual, verbal, emotional.
- ◆ **Trust, but verify** — blind & double-blind testing prove the dog works odor, not the handler.
- ◆ **The training record** — "the court knows only what you recorded"; document failures honestly.
- ◆ **The witness stand** — separate observation from interpretation; case law fluency (Harris, Jardines, Caballes, Rodriguez, Place, Edmond).

WHO HE IS

Biography & credibility (now written into the site)

- ◆ Grew up around working dogs; father's pointer **Sport** — positive reinforcement & compound behavior before they were terms.
- ◆ Military: HVAC technician, then **small-arms marksmanship instructor**.
- ◆ Introduced to fire/explosion investigation via a forensic engineer; trained his **first accelerant dog in 1999**; worked hundreds of fires; aided arson prosecutions.
- ◆ Added narcotics, explosives, cadaver, tracking; **pest-detection dogs ~2002**.
- ◆ Police academy **2003**; **Chief of Police 2007**; retired full-time LE **2015**.
- ◆ **FBI National Academy** graduate (Quantico) — his career highlight.
- ◆ **Author** and instructor; testifies as an **expert witness**.

Kip — the brand's namesake

Kip was David's accelerant dog, remembered for one quality: **honesty**. "Kip worked because he wanted to solve the odor problem... he did not seem compelled to manufacture an answer simply because someone expected one." Kip is why the legacy brand was **Kip K9** — a great story to keep telling.

What changed on the site

The About page is now his real story; a new **The Method** page presents his framework; Agencies/Consulting now lead with courtroom-defensibility and **expert-witness / litigation support**; three new articles teach the Five Phases, handler influence, and Florida v. Harris; the standard is unified as the **LSOC courtroom-defensible standard**.

Voice guide

Do

- ◆ Calm, exact, operator-to-operator.
- ◆ Describe behavior, then meaning ("the dog raised its head, turned into the wind, bracketed the seam...").
- ◆ Value honesty over bravado — even admit a dog can be wrong.
- ◆ Tie training to the courtroom.
- ◆ Respect the reader's intelligence.

Don't

- ◆ Never claim "100% accurate" or "never false alerts" — he explicitly rejects this.
- ◆ Don't frame the work as "beating" the defense or the system.
- ◆ Don't reduce a search to "the dog alerted."
- ◆ Avoid hype and superlatives without proof.

Signature lines (usable as pull-quotes)

- ◆ "The sit was not the discovery. It was the communication."
- ◆ "Every search is a conversation. The dog is talking."
- ◆ "Reliability is not something we claim. It is something we demonstrate."
- ◆ "Let the dog stop you. You don't stop the dog."
- ◆ "The court knows only what you recorded."

A few confirmations from David

These aren't blockers — the site reads well as-is — but David's answers will tighten it.

1 • The standard's name

The old site said "K9 Alliance Certification Standard"; the book brands everything **LSOC**. We've unified to "LSOC courtroom-defensible standard." Is K9 Alliance the same thing, a separate third-party cert he uses, or a legacy name to retire?

2 • The book

Final **title**, cover image, and the eventual **purchase link** (Amazon/other). The site already has a "coming soon" book callout ready to become a buy button.

3 • Expert-witness positioning

Confirm he wants expert-witness / litigation support featured publicly, and whether he takes **defense** work as well as prosecution (the book says he evaluates honestly for either — powerful, if he wants it stated).

4 • Proof

Still the priority — the Kip story and his bio are in; now the case studies, references, and video from the intake kit.